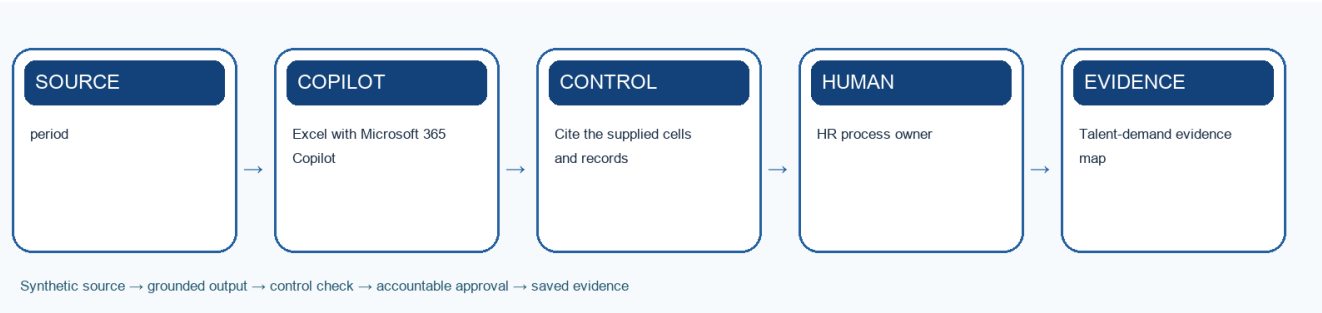


Lab 1: Assess Talent Needs with Copilot

Synthetic learning case: Do not upload live employee or candidate data.

Scenario

HarbourLight Logistics SG is opening a digitally enabled distribution hub. HR receives demand forecasts, overtime data, vacancy history and a skills inventory in separate files, so workforce decisions are slow and reactive.



Lab workflow schematic

Learning goal

Use Microsoft 365 Copilot to turn operational evidence into a transparent hire, redeploy or develop recommendation.

Microsoft tools

- Excel with Microsoft 365 Copilot
- Teams

Supplied mock data

Use mock-data.csv or the Mock Data sheet in Lab-01-Evidence-Workbook.xlsx. The records are specific to this scenario and carry forward the HarbourLight case.

Guardrails

- Cite the supplied cells and records
- Separate fact from forecast
- Business and HR owners approve the demand hypothesis

Detailed procedure

1. Review the synthetic demand, overtime, vacancy and skills-inventory evidence.
2. Define the business outcomes and time horizon for the new hub.
3. Ask Copilot to summarise demand drivers and cite the supporting cells.
4. Compare required capabilities with the current workforce skills inventory.
5. Create hire, redeploy, automate and develop options with assumptions and trade-offs.
6. Stress-test the preferred option against high- and low-demand scenarios.
7. Record the human-approved talent need, success measure and review date.
8. Pass the approved role outcomes and skills to Lab 2.

Product workbench

1. Sign in with the licensed training account. Use only the supplied synthetic mock-data.csv or evidence workbook; do not paste live HR records.
2. Open Lab-01-Evidence-Workbook.xlsx, inspect the Mock Data sheet and record the meaning of period and forecast_orders before prompting.
3. Save a working copy of the workbook in the approved OneDrive or SharePoint training location. In Excel, make the source range a named Table with headers, then open Copilot from the ribbon.
4. Ask Copilot to use the named table and cite period for each finding. Request an output table with evidence, uncertainty and an HR reviewer action.
5. Compare at least three claims with the original CSV rows. Write corrections and the exact prompt in the Evidence Log; do not treat a Copilot chart or summary as a final decision.

Microsoft product reference: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot-excel>

Prompt scaffold

You are supporting the HarbourLight Logistics SG training case. Use only the supplied synthetic evidence. Your task is to use microsoft 365 copilot to turn operational evidence into a transparent hire, redeploy or develop recommendation. State assumptions; cite record IDs or approved source sections; separate observation from inference; flag missing information; list the human checks and approvals required before use.

Evidence checklist

- ☐ Talent-demand evidence map
- ☐ Skills-gap analysis
- ☐ Hire-redeploy-develop recommendation
- ☐ Evidence workbook records the input/source, prompt or decision, output, verification, revision and owner.
- ☐ A peer or trainer can reproduce the reasoning from the saved evidence.

Acceptance criteria

- Cite the supplied cells and records
- Separate fact from forecast
- Business and HR owners approve the demand hypothesis
- The output is accurate, traceable, usable and explicit about uncertainty.
- Consequential decisions and actions remain with an authorised human.

Scenario questions

1. Which assumption most changes the talent need?
2. Where could automation reduce workload without removing accountability?
3. What evidence would trigger a plan revision?

Submission naming

L01-<YourName>-Evidence.xlsx plus the listed deliverables.

Source anchors

- Course source register: ../SOURCE-COVERAGE.md

- Microsoft capability boundary: Microsoft 365 Copilot for generative work; Agent Builder or Copilot Studio for agentic work.

Recommended team roles and timing

- HR process owner: confirms that the output solves the stated assess talent needs with copilot outcome and remains consistent with approved policy.
- AI operator or maker: records the exact prompt, instructions, knowledge sources, tool choices and revisions.
- Reviewer or approver: independently checks evidence, permissions, fairness, privacy and any consequential action.
- Evidence recorder: keeps the workbook complete enough for another person to reproduce the reasoning.

Allow about 35-50 minutes for the first build, 15 minutes for testing and verification, and 10 minutes for peer challenge and reflection. The trainer may adjust the timing to fit the delivery mode.

Test-it evidence

Record test ID, input, expected result, actual result, source citation, reviewer and pass/fail in the evidence workbook. For agent labs, use agent-test-cases.csv and capture the test conversation or run result before marking a case complete.

Verification method

1. Compare every factual statement or extracted item with the supplied source record.
2. Mark missing information as unknown; do not convert absence into a negative assumption.
3. Check that personal data, tool access and sharing are limited to the stated purpose.
4. Test one normal case, one ambiguous case, one out-of-scope case and one failure or exception.
5. Ask a peer to challenge the decision, then record whether you accepted or rejected the challenge and why.
6. Confirm the named human owner can correct, stop or reverse the work before submission.

Troubleshooting and recovery

- If Copilot invents evidence, narrow the prompt to named files, tables or record IDs and request citations.
- If an agent answers outside scope, strengthen instructions, remove inappropriate knowledge or tools, and add an explicit escalation response.
- If a flow fails or repeats an action, do not report success. Preserve the error, check the audit record, use a unique request key, and route the case to the human owner.
- If the output is polished but cannot be traced to evidence, treat it as incomplete and rebuild the evidence chain.